

Department of Computer Science

University of Gujrat, Gujrat, Pakistan

September 30, 2026

The Admissions Committee

Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering

University of Washington

Re: Letter of Recommendation for Ms. Hira Nawaz – PhD in Computer Science

Dear Members of the Admissions Committee,

I am pleased to recommend Ms. Hira Nawaz for admission to the PhD program in Computer Science at the University of Washington. I am her MS thesis supervisor in the Department of Computer Science at the University of Gujrat, and I also taught her the AI in Healthcare course. This has given me a close view of her academic performance, technical ability, and growth as an independent researcher.

Hira has an excellent academic record, with a 3.92/4.00 CGPA in her MS in Computer Science and 3.91/4.00 in her BS in Computer Science. Her research interests focus on trustworthy and explainable AI, medical imaging, multimodal learning, and healthcare AI.

Her current MS research, which I supervise, develops a conformalized vision-language model for radiology decision support using BiomedCLIP and PubMedBERT, incorporating uncertainty quantification, conformal prediction, and counterfactual explanations. Through this work she has gained experience in deep learning, computer vision, NLP, multimodal learning, experimental design, and quantitative evaluation of explanations. She has also conducted research in neuroimaging and explainable AI, including subject-wise validation and explanation analysis.

One of Hira's strongest qualities is her ability to work independently on challenging research problems. She actively learns new methods, critically evaluates experimental results, and responds constructively to feedback. Her research goes beyond model accuracy to address reliability, uncertainty, interpretability, and robustness, which are essential for AI systems intended for healthcare. Her interest in this area was also evident in my AI in Healthcare course.

Hira also communicates her research well. She has submitted a manuscript, "Towards Reliable Radiology Decision Support: A Composite Trust Score for Conformalized Vision-Language Models with Counterfactual Latent Explanations." This work has strengthened her skills in literature review, scientific writing, experimentation, and research dissemination.

Hira has the motivation, technical foundation, and research maturity to contribute to a rigorous research environment such as the Paul G. Allen School. I am confident she will approach doctoral research with intellectual curiosity, persistence, and a genuine commitment to advancing reliable AI, and I recommend her without reservation.

Please feel free to contact me if further information is required.

Sincerely,

Dr. Naveed Anwer Butt

Supervisor and Instructor, AI in Healthcare

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